

Friday, 11 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Drizzle 22° 16°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 21° 15°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 19° 14°	GLASGOW Light drizzle 16° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Labour mayors in England vow to cap tourist tax at 5%.

Reform UK and the Conservatives have criticised plans for the new levy on visitors' overnight stays.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Use all powers necessary on anti-migrant protests, home secretary tells police.

Two anti-migrant protests took place in Dover and Portsmouth last weekend.

UK · NEWS
- 3

Catherine joins William as he says sport can save lives from suicide.

The prince's new project aims to use the reach of sport to raise awareness about suicide and show people the help available in a crisis.

UK · NEWS
- 4

Four hurt and seven arrested in Bromley stabbing.

Seven people are arrested and police say there is no wider threat to the public.

UK · NEWS
- 5

Police and army mourn officer killed in crash.

Former army colleagues attend PC Tom Clough's funeral alongside police and emergency workers.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

- 1 Esther Ranzen says she is too fragile to travel to Switzerland to end life.**
The broadcaster and campaigner says she missed her chance to go before living with cancer became "unbearable".
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 2 New Strictly hosts explain their roles as they reject 'roving presenter' reports.**
Johannes Radebe, Josh Widdicombe and Emma Willis say their roles are not "fixed" or defined.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 3 BBC drops Drag Race UK after eight series.**
Future series will no longer be broadcast on BBC Three as the show moves to a streaming platform owned by its production company.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 4 Harry Styles extends tour, with Kylie as a support act.**
The pop star will play 25 more dates on his Together, Together tour, including three in the London.
SHOWBIZ · UK
- 5 Nicolas Cage's driveway collapses as sinkhole opens up at his Malibu home.**
A 30ft crater opened up outside the actor's home in Malibu after heavy rain in Southern California.
SHOWBIZ · UK

On the schedule

1

Arsenal close to finalising new contract for Arteta.

Mikel Arteta is believed to be close to finalising a new contract with Premier League champions Arsenal.

SPORT · UK

2

England's push for two-day win halted by weather.

England's charge towards a two-day victory in the final Test against Pakistan is only halted by rain at Edgbaston.

SPORT · UK

3

Hull & Woad to face Korda & Corpuz in Solheim opener.

Charley Hull and Lottie Woad will face the formidable pairing of Nelly Korda and Allisen Corpuz in Friday's opening match of the Solheim Cup in the Netherlands.

SPORT · UK

4

Can you make a case for Chelsea being stripped of 2016-17 title?.

Does Mauricio Pochettino have a case that Tottenham should be retrospectively crowned Premier League champions?

SPORT · UK

5

Team GB return after pregnancy 'hard to put into words' - Kinsella.

A year after giving birth, Alice Kinsella takes the latest step on her groundbreaking return to gymnastics at an international meeting for Team GB.

SPORT · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent study suggests that the gentle 'hum of a well-loved refrigerator' can be a surprising source of comfort for many.**
Researchers found that the familiar, steady background noise often evokes feelings of security and domestic bliss, especially after a busy day. It's the sound of home, apparently!
- 2 More people are embracing the quaint hobby of 'collecting interesting pebbles' found on their local walks.**
It's not just about the pebble itself, but the story of where it was found and the memory of the stroll. Some are even creating beautiful displays in their homes!
- 3 The charming tradition of 'leaving anonymous positive sticky notes' in public places is spreading small smiles and cheer.**
From library books to bus stops, little messages like 'You've got this!' or 'Have a lovely day' are making unexpected connections and brightening spirits. A lovely thought, isn't it?
- 4 A fascinating report highlights the rise in popularity of 'community bird feeder networks' in urban areas.**
Neighbours are coordinating to ensure local birds have a consistent food supply, turning their gardens into mini wildlife sanctuaries and fostering a sense of shared responsibility.
- 5 Gardeners are discovering the unexpected joy of talking to their houseplants, claiming it helps them thrive.**
Whether it's a gentle whisper of encouragement or a full-blown chat about the day, many green-fingered enthusiasts believe their plants respond positively to a bit of friendly banter.
- 6 A quirky new trend sees households 'repurposing old tea towels' into charming, rustic cushion covers.**
It's a creative way to give beloved textiles a new lease of life, adding a touch of nostalgic charm and personality to living spaces. Very thrifty, too!
- 7 The humble act of 'sorting through old photographs' is being championed as a powerful mood booster.**
Spending time with cherished memories, reliving happy moments, and connecting with the past is proving to be a wonderful way to unwind and feel grateful for bygone days.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: GIVING IT A LITTLE SNIFF – OR A 'WHIFF TEST'!

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of coffee, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: STIRRING IT CLOCKWISE EXACTLY THREE TIMES, THEN ANTI-CLOCKWISE THREE TIMES!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'shop or small business' just has a really unique and comforting smell?

Perhaps it's a bakery, a bookshop, or even an old hardware shop! Which shop instantly transports you with its scent, and what does it smell of?

- We all have those 'little rituals' we do on a weekday morning that just make the day feel like it's started right, don't we?

Whether it's a specific order of getting ready, a certain type of breakfast, or even a particular song – what's your non-negotiable morning ritual that sets you up for the day?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of ferrets is actually called a 'business'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Did you know that a group of badgers is actually called a 'huddle'?

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£12 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Wall of China is not visible from the moon with the naked eye.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, equal to one hundredth of a second.
- The world's smallest chameleon is smaller than a human fingernail.
- Bananas are technically berries, but strawberries are not.
- The inventor of the Pringles can is buried in one.
- It is estimated that more than 2,000 different types of cheese exist worldwide.
- The unicorn is the national animal of Scotland.

On this day

Day 254 of the year, 111 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Tendra Day (Russia); Christian feast days: Blessed Francesco Bonifacio; Christian feast days: Blessed Bonaventura Gran; Christian feast days: Deiniol. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1970 — Taraji P. Henson, American actress and singer
- 1945 — Leo Kottke, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1956 — Tony Gilroy, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1949 — Roger Uttley, English rugby player and coach
- 1930 — Cathryn Damon, American actress and dancer (died 1987)
- 1989 — Michael J. Willett, American actor and musician
- 1959 — John Hawkes, American actor
- 1965 — Moby, American singer-songwriter, musician, and DJ

THE DAY TODAY

- 2024 — Hurricane Francine impacts the Gulf of Mexico, as a Category 2 hurricane.
- 2024 — Soyuz MS-26 is launched to the International Space Station, setting a record of 19 people in orbit at the same time.
- 1973 — A coup in Chile, headed by General Augusto Pinochet, topples the democratically elected president Salvador Allende.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2024 — Hurricane Francine impacts the Gulf of Mexico, as a Category 2 hurricane.
- 1989 — Hungary announces that the East German refugees who had been housed in temporary camps were free to leave for West Germany.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1972 — The San Francisco Bay Area Rapid Transit system begins passenger service.
- 2024 — Soyuz MS-26 is launched to the International Space Station, setting a record of 19 people in orbit at the same time.

- 2008 — A major Channel Tunnel fire breaks out on a freight train, resulting in the closure of part of the tunnel for six months.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 255 of the year, 110 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ailbe (Elvis, Eilfyw) of Emly; Christian feast day: Guy of Anderlecht; Christian feast day: The Most Holy Name of the Blessed Virgin Mary; Christian feast day: John Henry Hobart (Episcopal Church (USA)). Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1940 — Linda Gray, American model and actress
- 1966 — Darren E. Burrows, American actor
- 1970 — Nathan Larson, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1942 — Maria Muldaur, American folk and blues singer
- 1994 — Druski, American comedian and actor
- 1930 — Larry Austin, American composer and educator (died 2018)
- 1991 — Mike Towell, Scottish professional boxer (died 2016)
- 1970 — Will Chase, American actor, director, and singer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1980 — Florida Commuter Airlines Flight 65 crashes into the Atlantic Ocean off West End, Bahamas, killing 34 people.
- 1988 — Hurricane Gilbert devastates Jamaica; it turns towards Mexico's Yucatán Peninsula two days later, causing an estimated \$5 billion in damage.
- 2003 — Iraq War: In Fallujah, U.S. forces mistakenly shoot and kill eight Iraqi police officers.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1992 — Abimael Guzmán, leader of the Shining Path, is captured by Peruvian special forces; shortly thereafter the rest of Shining Path's leadership fell as well.
- 1991 — NASA launches Space Shuttle Discovery on STS-48 to deploy the Upper Atmosphere Research Satellite.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar